

Discovery of a Hidden Painting Treasure

Amedeo Modigliani's

Sitting Nude with Crossed Hands, (c.) 1917



Subject - Alice Prin - age 16

Would become known as

"Kiki de Montparnasse" in 1922

Kiki, "Queen of Montparnasse" in 1929

throughout was THE "Essential Interlocutor"

for two generations of Modi's Peers

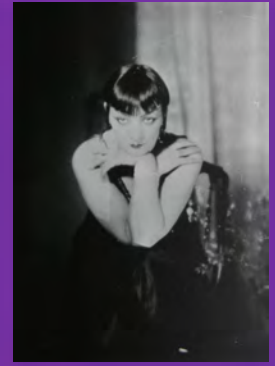
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Quote was Kiki's Memoirs - 1930 English Edition - Chapter XV Montparnasse Life 1917 - Speaking about Restaurant "Chez Rosalie's" {Lilliputian Historical Site} - only four tables where Alice worked for several months - 1914-15 **Quote: "The customer who got her goat the most of all was Modigliani. All he did was growl; he used to make me shiver from head to foot. But maybe he wasn't so good looking!**

Original Painting - Alice Ernestine Prin at age 16.

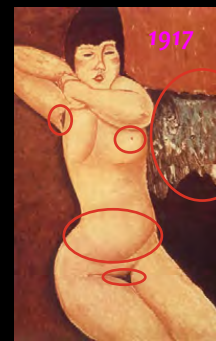
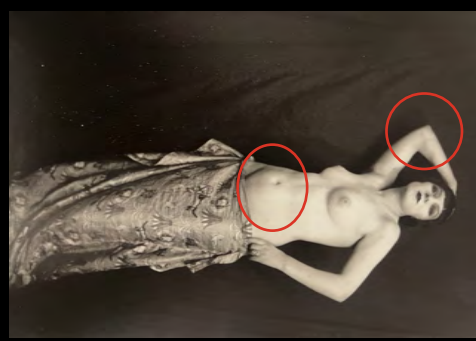
Amedeo Modigliani of course did not know that the subject of his painting would, at age 28 be officially crowned **Kiki, "Queen of Montparnasse"**

Artist Rendition - below depicts how Modigliani's painting will appear after cleaning and minor restoration. The painting, oil on canvas, below was created using the same color palate as Modigliani.



Two Paintings by Modigliani recently attributed to model/muse Alice Prin - (c.) 1917 - more on pages
 "Lying Nude with Joined Hands" (c.) 1917 - Ceroni & "Unnamed" (c.) 1917

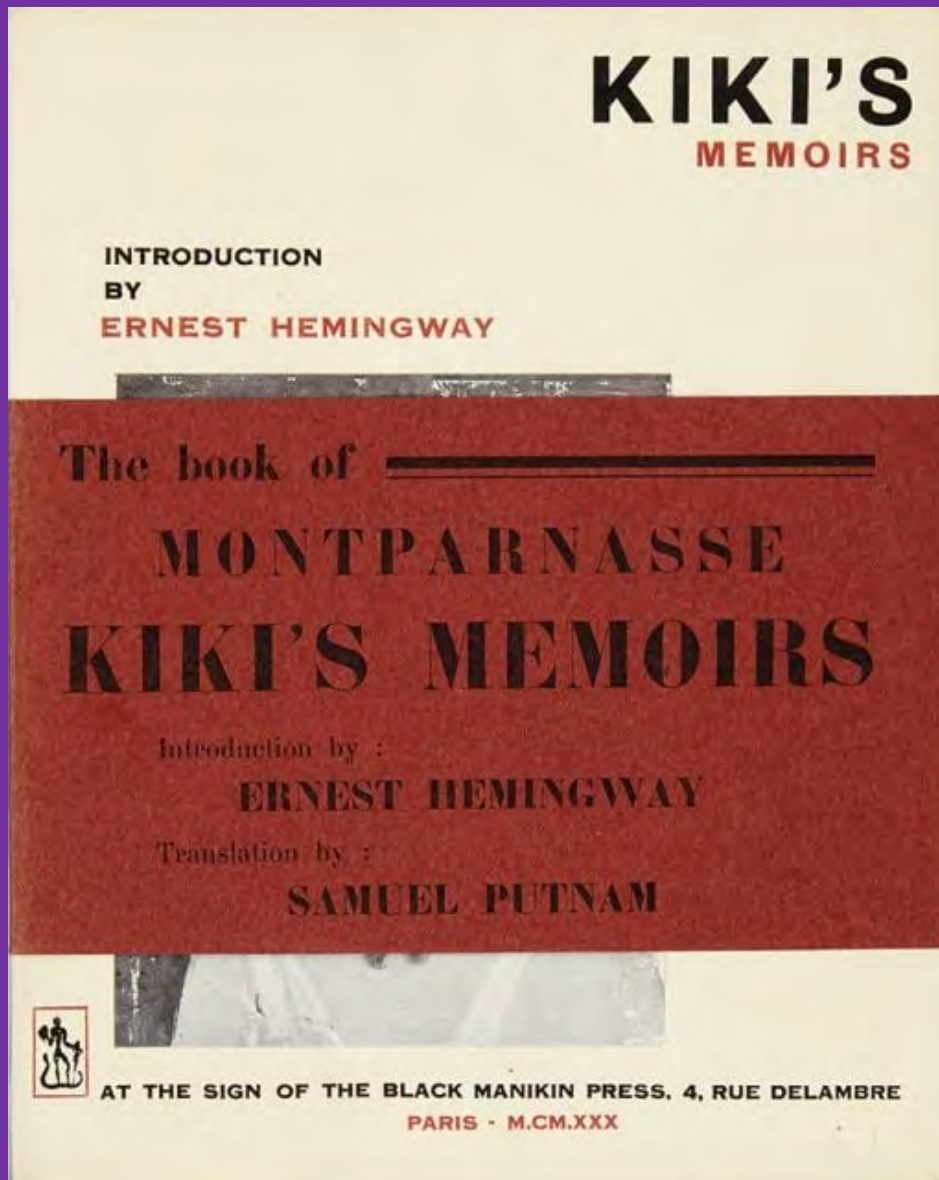
Below is an image of Modigliani's "Lying Nude with Hands Joined" (c.) 1917. The Unnamed painting to the right is also by Modigliani and obviously the same model. After conducting a full evaluation of the available materials on the painting it is highly likely the subject of both these paintings was Modigliani's favorite muse, Alice Prin. Convincing are features around the face, nose, mouth, eyebrows, bob haircut. These elements eerily consistent with Pacific Arts Collection's painting done of Alice in 1917. Also similar is the title of our painting, "**Sitting Nude with Crossed Hands**" that matches an entry on the Berthe Weill 1917 exhibition. Further similarities in both works are the fleshy arms, breasts, hips and pubic hair. Both are signed in black, bottom right. Worth note the presence of the work in Ceroni means the publisher, Ambrogio Ceroni reviewed the painting, its provenance and had conversations and meetings with the painting's owner.



Kiki wrote and partially Illustrated Kiki's Memoirs at the age of 28
Ernest Hemingway wrote an 6-pg Forward, one of only two he would do in his life

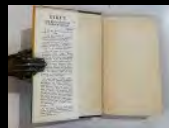
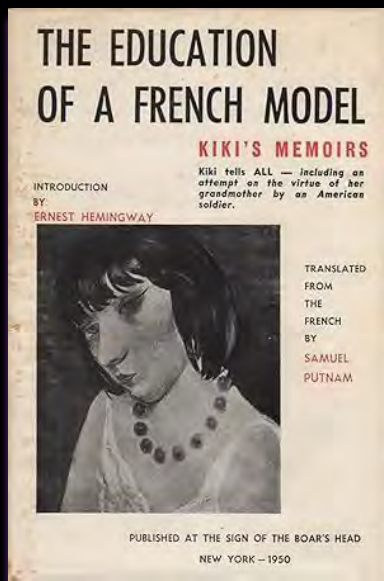
Kiki's Memoirs - translated from French to English by Samuel Putnam
Published in the US by Black Manikin Press

KIKI SOUVENIRS, Kiki de Montparnasse, 1929, First Edition - 2-min video - narrator leafing thru pgs



The Memoirs of Kiki de Montparnasse in the original French edition of 1929. Alice Prin, better known as "Kiki", was a bohemian creativity, an embodiment of the Parisian culture of the 1920s. She was an artist in her own right, but also a muse and model for Man Ray, Modigliani, Foujita, Moïse Kisling and many other artists. Her memoirs cover her life to date beginning with her childhood.

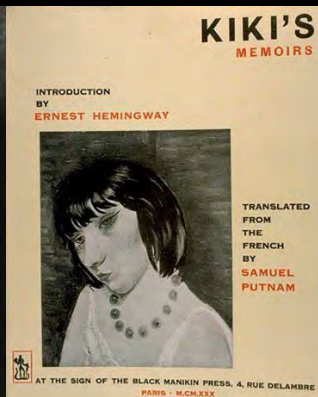
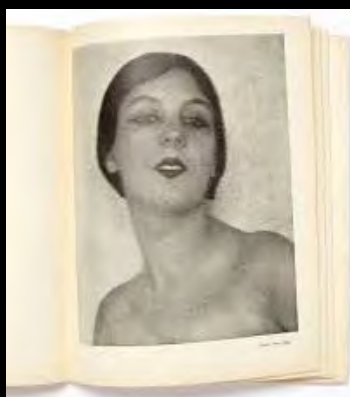
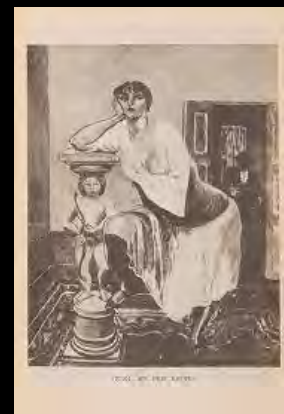
Chapters include Man Ray, En Posant, Monsieur W, Le Jockey, Villefranche 1925, En Prison and Montparnasse. The text is accompanied by twenty reproductions of Kiki's paintings, 10 black & white photographs by Man Ray, some photographs and illustrations by Kiki and reproductions of portraits by Foujita, Kisling, Hermine David, Per Krohg, Mayo and Tono Salazar. The book was published in English in 1930 with a new Forward written by Ernest Hemingway, one of two in his life. Although, Kiki's Memoirs was banned by the US until the 1970's for its explicit content.

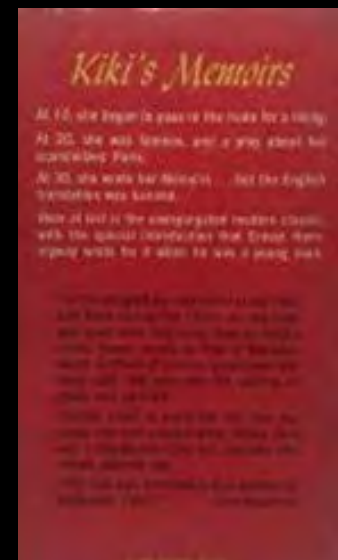
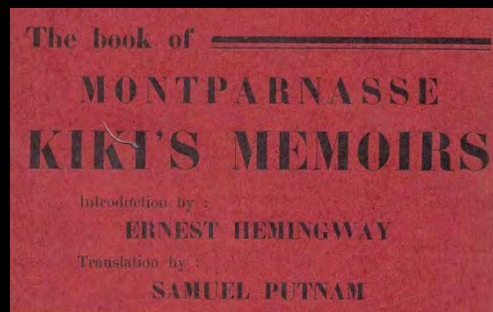
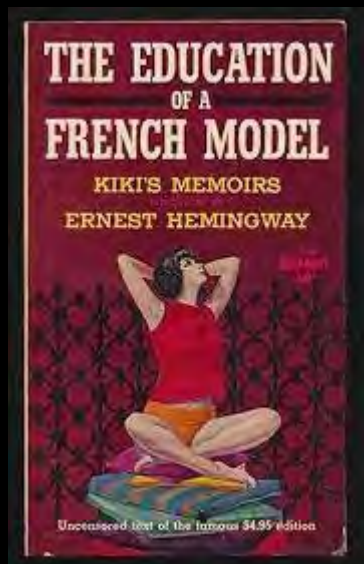


Title: The Education of a French Model:
Publisher: Boar's Head Books, 1950

181pp+ index and advertisements, illustrations, black and white drawings, photos, art reproductions, title page reads 'The Education of French Model: The Loves, Cares, Cartoons and Caricatures of Alice Prin, originally 'Souvenires Kiki' in French and Kiki's Memoirs in English,' [1929 and 1930], the edge worn top and tail of spine with a very small closed tear top rear panel, but not price-clipped and otherwise fine, clean and now in protective sleeve, fine yellow cloth with black titles and ornament, internally appears unread and an excellent clean tight unmarked copy, becoming harder to find.

Memoirs Hardcover – November 21, 1996 by Kiki (Author)





The Education of a French Model - Kiki's Memoirs.

Description

Attractive 1962 paperback edition of the era defining memoirs of Alice Prin, aka Kiki, "Queen of Montparnasse" with an introduction by Ernest Hemingway and fraudulent later chapters about their meeting in New York with the arch-pirate and publisher Samuel Roth.

Alice Prin, better known as Kiki, "Queen of Montparnasse", was a model and artist's muse in Paris most commonly associated with the avant garde art scene of the interwar years. A nude model for artists starting at the age of 14, Kiki's most famous image is likely Man Ray's photograph *Violin D'Ingres*.

This text, the story of her rise to prominence originally published as *Kiki's Memoirs* in 1928 and translated in English by Samuel Putnam in 1930 with a foreword by Ernest Hemingway calling it the best recollection of the spirit of Jazz Age, Paris he could find (he would later try his own hand in revisiting the same period in his memoir, *A Moveable Feast*).

Declared obscene in the United States and banned (and therefore out of copyright), New York bookseller and publisher Samuel Roth began publishing various pirated editions without the author's name (or any offer of royalties) as he had with other texts like James Joyce's *Ulysses* and D.H. Lawrence's *Lady Chatterley's Lover*. (Roth was also the unsuccessful defendant in the 1957 Supreme Court Case *Roth vs. The United States*, which ruled he could not sell the "obscene" magazine *American Aphrodite* through the mail).

Unique to Roth's editions of *Kiki's Memoirs* (sold under the title "The Education of a French Model") are the additional later chapters describing Kiki discovering her book's fame and traveling to New York to meet with "that archpirate" Samuel Roth and reunite with Ernest "Papa" Hemingway 23 years after the close of the original narrative.

The prominence of Hemingway's placement on the cover and in the story are almost undoubtedly connected to his suicide in Ketchum, Idaho in late 1961. (The same year as this publication, Roth followed the suicide of Marilyn Monroe with a controversial tell-all supposedly written by her psychiatrist).

8vo, 125pp + 2 ads. Perfectbound in printed paper wraps. Wear to corners and spine ends. Bookblock and pages darkened but clean. Small stain fore margin pg 89. Good condition.

The Education of a French Model: Kiki's Memoirs, Kiki Tells All (Including an Attempt on the Virtue of Her Grandmother)

KIKI [Alice Prin] with Samuel Putnam (translated with Ernest Hemingway Introduction)

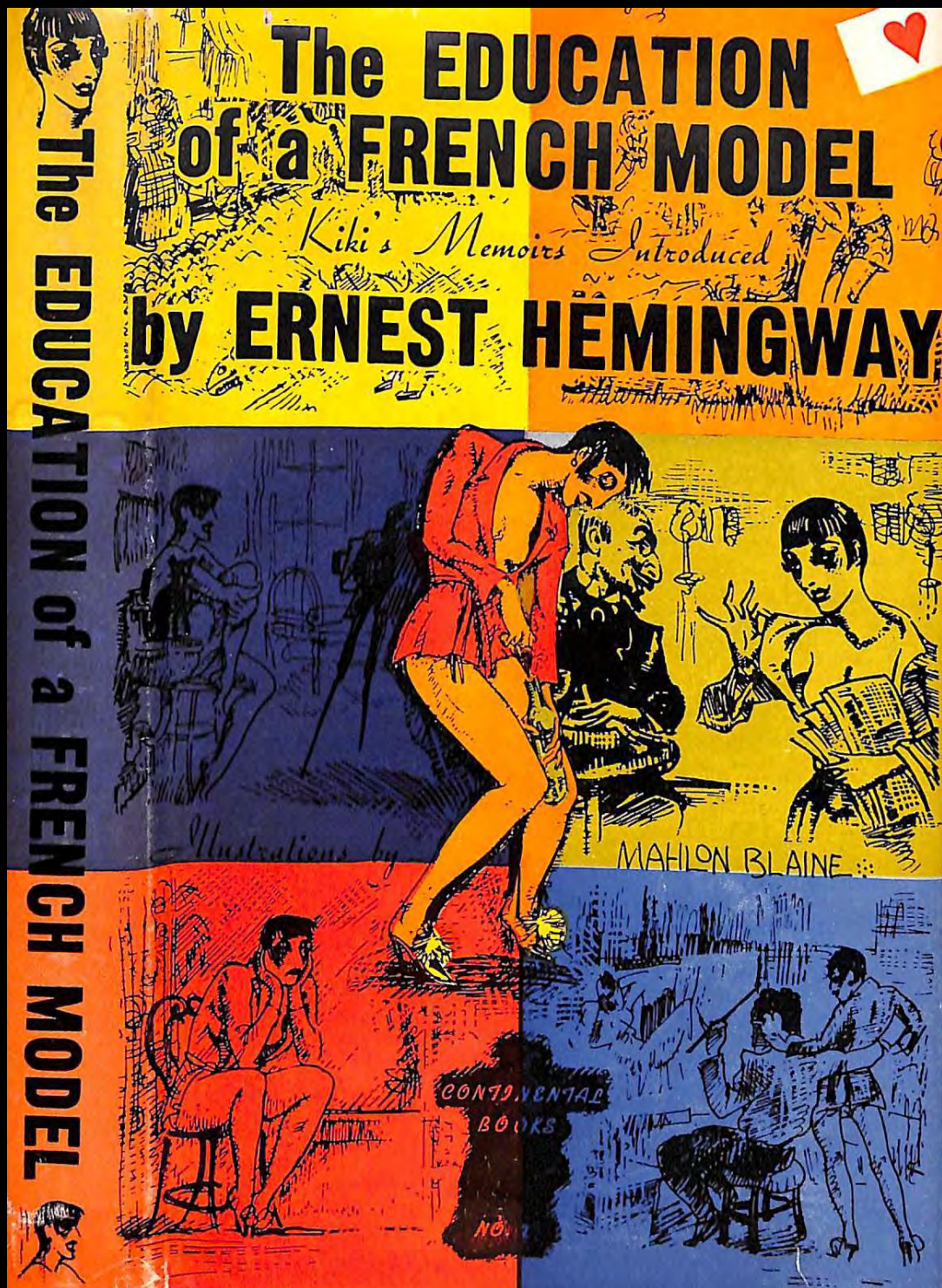
XXX
KIKI

Ernest Hemingway

Edn. 750 copies.

Bookman Press
Ed. A. Titus

Publisher of This Quarter w. Remondel
husband of Helena Reichenstein, subsequently
known as cosmetic firm.



The Education of a French Model - Introduction by Ernest Hemingway Kiki (a.k.a. Alice Ernestine Prin) (9-2-1901 - 4-29-1953) In 1929 given the title of KIKI, "Queen of Montparnasse" and in 1922 known as "Kiki de Montparnasse". Kiki was a French model, chanteuse, memoirist and painter during the Jazz Age. She flourished in, and helped define, the liberated culture of Paris in the so-called *Années folles* ("crazy years"). She became one of the most famous models of the 20th century and in the history of avant-garde art. [160] pp.

Bridgehead Books/Seven Sirens Press, Inc. 1955 Illustrations by Mahlon Blaine - With 16 pages of black & white nude photos of "Kiki's Friends". Translated by Samuel Putnam.

Ernest Hemingway wrote the 4-pg Forward to Kiki's Memoir's (one of two in his life) saying...."This is the only book I have ever written an introduction for, and God help me, the only one I ever will."

The Education Of A French Model
Kiki's Memoirs
Introduction by Ernest Hemingway



"Wouldn't you like to eat, Kiki?"

INTRODUCTION

by

Ernest Hemingway

There are enough photographs of Kiki in this book so you can have some idea how she looked in the ten years that are just over. This is being written in nineteen hundred and twenty-nine and Kiki now looks like a monument to herself and to the era of Montparnasse that was definitely marked as closed when she, Kiki, published this book.

Decades end every ten years dating from any original occurrence, such as the birth of Christ, or the end of the war, but eras can end any time. No one knows when they begin, at least not at the time, and the ones that are noted and advertised at the start usually do not stand up very long; the Era that was to start with Locarno, for instance.

An Era is easy to start in the newspapers; editorial writers start them regularly, but people forget all about them and they have nothing to do with real Eras. I hope no one will be rude enough at this point to consult a dictionary and find out what an Era really and exactly is because that might spoil all this big writing. The essential in big writing is to use words like the West, the East, Civilization, etc., and very often these words do not mean a damned thing but you cannot have big writing without them. My own experience has been that when you stand with your nose toward the north, if your head is held still, what is on your right will be east and what is on your left will be west and you can write very big putting those words in capitals but it is very liable not to mean anything.

However to get back to Eras, which is another big way of writing, although nobody knows when they start

The Education Of A French Model - Kiki's Memoirs
Forward by Ernest Hemingway
One of two he would do in his life



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MONTPARNASSE TODAY

Here I am, back in Montparnasse, which to me is the land of liberty. As I see it, I can cut up all I want to here, without being afraid of having to go eat beans again.

Folks here are broad-minded, and what would be a crime anywhere else is simply a little false pass.

Montparnasse, so picturesque, so colorful! All the peoples of the earth have come here to pitch their tents; and yet, it's all just like one big family.

In the morning, you can see young fellows in wide trousers and fresh-cheeked young girls on their way to the art-schools, to Watteau's, to Colarossi's, to the Grande Chaumiere, etc . . . Later, the cafe-terraces begin to fill up, and pretty Americans eating oatmeal can be

Below left - Photo of Kiki - 1928 - Pg 77 - One of over 20 black & white nude & partial nude photos of Kiki and some of her friends. Note

Characteristics in 1928 Photo of Kiki, taken just before she was officially crowned, Kiki, "Queen of Montparnasse"

- Kiki's signature slightly extended lipstick line - seen in many photos/paintings
- Body type, hands, fingers, nose, navel all are consistent with other closeup photography
- Kiki had a condition that prevented growth of pubic hair - a fact not widely circulated in artistic circles.

There is a scene in the French Animated film, where Foujita discovers this in a light moment - It is well known that Kiki asked all the artists and photographers she modeled for to make accommodations to keep her secret. The artists obliged although several photographers did not follow her instruction and did not retouch the negatives, including three below by Julien Mandel.



Animated Film - Mademoiselle Kiki et les Montparnos - 2013 Short Film- French w/ English subtitles

See animated film at 5:23 to 5:57 of humorous scene with Foujita and Kiki when he first confronts her about her hair anomaly. The information also confirmed at _____ of the conversation with art historian and author Ellen de Belerville and another Kiki expert.

Key moments in animated film:

- 0:07 - Kiki's Childhood and Family
- 1:46 - Kiki of Montparnasse
- 2:09 - Kiki's First Flirtation with Utrillo
- 4:41 - Kiki's Insinuation of a relationship with Modigliani
- 5:23 - Kiki's with Foujita - modeling session
- 6:37 - Kiki's Career in the Movies
- 7:40 - Kiki's Success at the Jockey Club
- 8:45 - Kiki's Love Life with Henri Broca
- 10:15 - Kiki's Memoirs at the Falstaff
- 12:39 - Kiki and Titine's First Flirtation



25-min Conversation w/author & historian Ellen de Bellerville & Kiki Biographer

Edith de Belleville is a well known tour guide in Paris, a lawyer historian and author. She wrote a book in French about inspirational Parisian women from the past "Belles et Rebel les " (Edition du 81) She also teaches Jewish heritage in Paris at Gustave Eiffel University (Marne-La-Vallée).

Left/center right - Julien Mandel - 1915-16 - 2 photos were used for erotic postcards

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